

2. "Eyes on the Waves"

(Inspired by Matthew 14:22-33 — ~5-6 minutes)

The sea was restless that night.

The disciples had known storms before—sharp winds, splintering waves—but this one felt different. The boat creaked and groaned as if protesting the command to keep going. Darkness pressed in from every side.

"Why did He send us ahead?" someone shouted over the wind.

No one answered.

Then—movement.

A figure walked toward them, feet touching water as if it were solid ground. Fear gripped the boat. Grown men cried out like children.

"It's a ghost!"

But then came a voice they knew. Calm. Certain. "Take courage. It is I. Do not be afraid."

Peter's heart pounded. If it was truly Jesus, then the impossible was suddenly possible. He leaned forward, gripping the edge of the boat. "Lord, if it's You... tell me to come."

Jesus didn't hesitate. "Come."

Peter swung his legs over the side. The wind howled. The water surged. And yet—he stood.

One step. Then another.

For a moment, the storm faded. All Peter saw was Jesus. The waves were still there, the wind still violent, but faith held him steady.

Then doubt whispered.

What are you doing? This isn't possible. Look at the water. Look at the storm.

Peter looked.

The waves rose higher. The wind slammed into him. Fear flooded his chest, and just as quickly as courage had lifted him, terror pulled him down.

He sank.

"Lord, save me!"

Immediately—immediately—Jesus reached out and caught him.

"You of little faith," Jesus said, not in anger but in love. "Why did you doubt?"

Together, they climbed into the boat. And just like that, the storm stilled. Silence fell heavy and holy.

The disciples stared, breathless.

"Truly," they whispered, "You are the Son of God."

Peter sat soaked and shaking, water dripping from his beard. He had failed—but he had also walked on water. He had known what it was to trust completely, even if only for a moment.

And long after the sea had gone calm, Peter remembered this: it wasn't the storm that caused him to sink—it was taking his eyes off the One who called him out of the boat.